

Rich Palmer

Graphic Designer + Digital Designer

Experienced designer. Passionate about creativity, obsessed with the details. Embracing new technology, trusting traditional principles.

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

A highly experienced and versatile graphic and digital designer based in Nottingham in the UK. During an extensive career in the creative industry, I've worked on pretty much everything that comes my way with a drive and enthusiasm that has been the core to my success in the industry. Design for me has always been part instinct, part discipline. I've spent my career helping brands say what they mean clearly, memorably and with a bit of edge, working across branding, print, digital, ecommerce and campaign design.

Right now I'm designing across Pentland Brands' global portfolio – Speedo, Berghaus, Ellesse, Canterbury, Mitre, Kickers and Endura – spanning ecommerce, digital campaigns and brand systems across multiple international markets. I am also helping to drive the companies move into the use of AI, being selected as one of Pentland's AI Entrepreneurs, I'm helping to deliver real-world uses for this technology and identifying where AI can be a genuinely useful addition to our daily toolkit. My attitude to new technology has always been one of adopt and adapt, and make it work for us.

Colleagues would tell you I'm calm under pressure, straight-talking, and happier solving a problem than complaining about one. I still believe good design rests on the same principles it always has – I just enjoy bending the rules, embracing new tools, and creating a bit of useful chaos to get there.

Pentland Brands 2023 – Present

Designing creative assets across Pentland's global portfolio of sports and lifestyle brands, spanning ecommerce, digital marketing, crm, social media, print and internal communications.

- Design across Speedo, Berghaus, Ellesse, Mitre, Canterbury, Kickers and Endura, working within multiple distinct global visual identity systems side by side, ensuring consistent & cohesive comms across a wide range of internal functions.
- Produce ecommerce content, digital campaigns, social assets, B2B communications and print collateral for international markets.
- Selected as one of Pentland's AI Entrepreneurs – helping the wider internal teams explore, test and adopt AI tools in real production workflows, not just experiment with them.
- Collaborate daily with international creative, marketing and production teams; help shape briefs and improve how the creative functional team delivers at pace.

Impact: Trusted to deliver for globally recognised brands while keeping quality and brand consistency intact across multiple markets.

Hullabaloo Visual Communications 1999 – 2022

Many years served here with a steady rise through the ranks. Was fundamental in the company's shift from print into digital. Progressed from Graphic Designer to eventually becoming the Creative Lead, directing branding, print, digital, exhibition and web projects for clients ranging from global manufacturers to local independents.

- Led creative direction on hundreds of projects across branding, print, digital and exhibition.
- Built client relationships that lasted a decade or more – several are still on my Selected Clients list today.
- Mentored junior designers and helped define studio standards as the work moved from being print-based to adopting a digital-focussed workflow.
- Worked as part of a close-knit team to build fun, positive, fast-paced studio – always promoted a 'can-do' attitude.

Earlier Career

Business Design Agency (1998), Red Rock Design (1992–1997), Remo Print (1987–1991) – the decade that built the foundations: print production, typography, layout and branding, and the discovery of desktop publishing that set the direction for everything since.

www.chaos-lab.com

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WHAT I BRING

Brand Identity & Brand Systems
Creative Campaigns & Art Direction
Digital, UX/UI & Ecommerce Design
Creative Artworking & Print Production
Typography & Visual Storytelling
AI-Augmented Creative Workflows
Creative Leadership & Mentoring
Stakeholder Collaboration & Pitching
End-to-End Project Delivery
Adobe Creative Cloud & Figma
Internal and External Collaborations

SELECTED CLIENTS

Pentland Brands

Speedo / Berghaus / Ellesse / Canterbury
Mitre / Kickers / Endura

ASSA ABLOY

Yale
Somfy
ICI Dulux

TOOLS, TECH & AI

The tools I use to make ideas real, and the ones I'm exploring to make them faster, sharper, or just more interesting.

Adobe Creative Cloud:

Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, After Effects

AI:

ChatGPT, Gemini, Firefly, Claude etc

Figma

WORKING STYLE

I enjoy turning a good brief into great creative, and I'm happiest working collaboratively – asking questions early and solving problems before they become obstacles.

Colleagues know me as calm under pressure, honest about what's achievable, and always willing to roll up my sleeves. I'm as interested in where design is going as where it's been, which is why I keep pulling new tools and techniques into how I work.

OUTSIDE DESIGN

Outside of work I'm usually found on a mountain bike, camping with the family, or building furniture in the garage. I like making things – timber, pixels or ideas, and that curiosity is exactly what keeps me excited about where design goes next.